

The Healed World

PLAYER'S COMPENDIUM

VERSION 1.0

You are about to wake up as something the world stopped believing in centuries ago.

Not a wizard. Not a superhero. An *ancient thing* wearing a human life the way you'd wear a borrowed coat — one that fits almost perfectly, right up until it doesn't. Somewhere underneath the person you'll build at this table is something older than language — it knew fire, tide, and moonlight before humans had names for any of them. There were ages when people did not fear what you are — they knelt for it. You were called holy once. A demigod, in the oldest and truest sense: not human, and not pretending to be.

You were never the only secret humanity kept, though. Orders and societies have known about your kind for centuries — some hunt you outright, some would rather capture and use you, and all of them have a plan for how the world ought to be run. In every one of those plans, you are either a tool, a threat, or both. You just don't know yet which of them is already watching.

You won't remember much at first. That's the point. Your character wakes up in early-1990s Norway — cassette tapes, satellite dishes, a country that has quietly forgotten it ever had older gods — with a handful of broken fragments where a past should be. A stone you might have cut yourself, a thousand years ago, for reasons that don't fully add up anymore. A king you might have watched become a saint. A blade that was too bright to be only a blade. You get to choose which pieces are yours. *You don't get to choose what they mean — not yet.*

What this book gives you is exactly that: the pieces. What your character remembers, what the world looks like on the surface, and the tools to start pulling threads. Whether you trust what you're told, what you decide your fragments mean, what you're willing to do once you understand the cost — that's the part only play can answer.

Welcome back. It's been a long sleep.

Your Nephilim wakes with its past in pieces. These entries are not history; they are **what remains** — fragments, aching and half-dissolved, surfacing like something seen underwater. Choose the lives whose fragments feel like yours. What they *meant* is not yet given to you; that is the game.

YEAR / PERIOD	NAME THEN	NAME NOW	TITLE
536 A.D.	Qgvaldsnes	Avaldsnes (Karmøy)	<i>Fimbulvetr</i> (the great winter)
c. 650–700 A.D.	Sygnafylki (Eggja)	Sogn (Sogndal)	<i>Frœða rúnar</i> (the lore of the runes)
c. 793–830 A.D.	Skíringssalr (Kaupang)	Kaupang (Larvik)	<i>Vestrfor</i> (the westward voyage)
c. 872 A.D.	Hafrsfjorðr / Qgvaldsnes	Hafrsfjord / Avaldsnes	<i>Eitt ríki</i> (one kingdom)
1024–1031 A.D.	Niðarós	Trondheim	<i>Óláfr hinn helgi</i> (Olav the Holy)
1349 A.D.	Björgvin	Bergen	<i>Manndauðr</i> (the great dying)
c. 1620–1663 A.D.	Vargøy	Vardø	<i>Mørketid</i> (the polar dark)

❹

Opala

The table runs oldest to youngest — the order the lives must be chosen in.

❸

Jera

Roughly 1,100 years of Norwegian history separate the first and last past life.

Choose freely, but in order. Pick any of the lives below, in **chronological order**; a Nephilim incarnates only once in any period.

History costs power. Each past life lowers your starting Ka by 2 (and your current life costs 2 more). Deep history or raw strength — not both; your GM sets the pool.

The shared life is free. Every character also lived **Ogvaldsnes, 536**; that one is granted to all of you and **costs no Ka**.

The era decides what, not how much. Every past life from Avaldsnes (536) through Niðarós (1031) offers the same occult range — Sorcery through Grand Secret, Summoning through Pentacles — verified against the rulebook's own period tables, not a simplified "older = weaker" curve. Alchemy is the one real gate: unavailable before the 12th century, so it first appears at Björgvin (1349) and grows further at Vardø (1620s).

Roll or choose. Where a life lists a **Simulacrum** or **Stasis** table, you may either roll the dice shown or simply pick the entry that fits your character (the GM's ruling is final).

Points come from age, not the era. Each life gives **Simulacrum Skill Points** = Simulacrum's age $(3d6 \times 5) \times 4$, and **Occult Development Points** = years lived $(3d6 \times 5) \times 2$, plus free **Life Experience** (= age) and **Speak Language** $((2d6+6) \times 5)$. The era decides only *what* you may spend them on.

Your Stasis need not be from here. The object that holds your Ka between lives is fixed in your *first* incarnation — but objects of value travel: looted, gifted, traded, buried far from where they were made.

Dominant Arcanum is a clue, not a chain. Each life sheet names the tribe that shaped its era — the Nephilim who were active, organized, and influential when you lived it. You are not bound to that tribe yourself; per the rulebook, you may wait to choose your own Arcanum affiliation until you've seen which ones ran through your own past lives, then decide where you actually belong.

↑

Ka

Ka is the vital energy of the Nephilim, without which it cannot exist. It is neither energy, matter nor spirit, but rather all of those in one substance.

X

Simulacrum

The mortal shell a Nephilim wore in that life — chosen or rolled, never the demigod itself.

Qgvaldsnes

Fimbulvetr — the great winter

536



A WORD, AND A SICK CHILD COOLED

B *Before the cold, there was the hall.* That is where you should begin, because it is where you were whole. Woodsmoke and wet wool and the warmth of too many bodies, and you above them on the high seat — not hidden, not feared as a stranger, but known. They spoke your name the way one speaks a prayer. It was a gentler age for your kind: no crosses yet, no one to burn you for the shape of your soul, and so you wore it openly. A hand laid flat, and the fire leaned toward you. A word, and a sick child cooled. They loved you and used you and called you down to mend what broke, and you mended it, and it was good to be the thing they turned to. You were the lesser fear. You did not yet know there was a greater one coming.

I *Fimbulvetr*

The mythic three-year winter without summer; here, the climate collapse of 536.

F *Qgvaldsnes*
Royal seat on Karmøy, commanding the Karmsundet strait.

< *North Way*
Karmsundet let ships bypass open sea — the strait gave Norway its name, and Avaldsnes its toll.

Then the cold. Not a memory you reach for — one that reaches for you, always, the way the sea reaches up the sand. The sun had gone thin: noon like dusk, dusk like the inside of a shut eye, a summer that simply did not come, and then another. The fields failed and the animals were kept too close and the people starved by the shape of the sky. And the faces that had turned to you in love turned to you now in terror, because a god should be able to stop this — and you believed, this is the part you must be careful with, because you believed it so completely, that you understood the whole machinery of it grinding wrong beneath the world, and that it could be mended, and what mending would take.

Here is what you cannot put down. You were not afraid of the price, and you were not brave about it either. You looked at the ruin and the cost side by side, the way a fair man looks at a scale, and you judged that the cost was owed — that the world was out of true and someone had to pay it back into true, and that it should be those who could. You did not weep. You decided. And some nights you think that clarity was the finest thing you ever were. And some nights, now, you are not sure the scale was ever real — whether you read the world truly, or only told yourself a shape you could bear to act on.

There were others who decided with you — three, perhaps four. You have lost their faces the way you lost the count of them, and that is the cruelest theft, because you know you loved them: when you reach for them now there is only warmth, and the shape of an absence.

And then the walking, which you remember only as an emptying — you poured yourself out onto the frozen ground until there was less of you than before, and you did it gladly, because the scale would balance. The cold broke after. Whether it broke because of you, or would have cleared on its own and you paid for nothing — that you did not know, standing there emptied on the ice, and the not-knowing is the part that followed you: quiet as frost forming, a question that never quite thawed.

WHAT YOU MUST ANSWER AT THE TABLE

When the cost came clear — did you lay yourself down first, or hang back, and never forgive the hesitation? Did you lead the others into that emptying, or follow? And when you say you did it gladly — is that memory, or the story you have told yourself so long you can no longer hear the difference?

◦

536 CE

Tree-ring and ice-core records mark 536 as the start of the coldest decade in 2,000 years.

↑

Justice (XI)

The Arcanum dominant in this life. A debt weighed, and seen paid.

Qgvaldsnes · 536 A.D.

AVALDSNES, KARMØY · *Fimbulvetr*

The shared, free life. See the fragment above for what remains of it; below is only what you choose.

OCCULT ART AVAILABLE

Sorcery — **Lower, Higher and Grand Secret** techniques; Summoning — **Seals and Pentacles**.

DOMINANT ARCANUM

Justice (XI). *You were the kind who weighs a debt and sees it paid, whatever the cost, to whoever owes it — including yourself.*

SIMULACRUM <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–10	a goði (cult-leader)
11–25	a pilot of the strait , guiding ships through Karmsundet
26–45	a chieftain's retainer / warrior
46–58	a völva or healer
59–70	a smith
71–85	a trader off the North Way
86–00	a thrall

STASIS OBJECT <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–20	a gilded Continental relief-brooch (a Frankish import)
21–45	a gold bracteate — a northern amulet struck after Roman medallions
46–60	a pierced Roman/Byzantine gold solidus worn as a pendant
61–72	a Rhenish claw-beaker of glass, or a worked amber piece
73–85	a rune-cut whetstone-sceptre
86–00	a boat-grave fitting
<i>A Migration-Period treasure; value rode the North Way, so a far-carried object fits Karmsundet well.</i>	

X

Free life

Every character lived this one; it costs no Ka.

R

goði

A chieftain-priest who held both the cult and the assembly.

ƚ

völva

A seeress who worked seiðr; welcomed and feared in equal part.

NOTABLE ERA SKILLS

Norse Lore · Seafaring & the strait · Healing · Runes · Sorcery (Lower) · Oratory / leadership.

Sygnafylki

Fræða rúnar — the lore of the runes

c. 650–700



CUTTING THE RUNE INTO STONE

You remember the pride first, because that is where it still hurts. There was an age when your kind walked in the open and the people watched you and understood nothing of it — and you could not bear the watching-without-knowing, so you gave them a way to hold what they saw. Marks. This one the fire; this one the cold that stops everything; this one the road the gods walk. You put the shapes of the world into their hands and called it mercy, and for a while it was.

And there was one time you did not give it away. A place that felt heavier than the others, and for the first time you doubted the gift itself — whether teaching them to remember was mercy or a weapon set in the wrong hands. So you hid it instead, and knew in the same breath that this, too, was wrong: to hide is to pretend the danger is gone because no one sees it. You do not know which was worse — the pride that gave them too much, or the fear that took back what you had already given.

WHAT YOU MUST ANSWER AT THE TABLE

Did you cut the stone to keep the place safe — or because you could not bear the knowing to die with you? Caution, or vanity wearing caution's face? And if you met those marks again, in a stranger's hand — would the pride come first, or the fear?

R

Eggjum stone

Found face-down under a grave slab at Eggja farm, Sogndal, in 1917; carries the longest known Elder Futhark text.

B

~200 signs

Its inscription is still debated by runologists — the longest and most enigmatic of the early carvings.

Sygnafylki (Eggja), Sogn

C. 650-700 A.D. · *Frœða rúnar*

See the fragment above for what remains of it; below is only what you choose.

OCCULT ART AVAILABLE

Sorcery — **Lower, Higher and Grand Secret** techniques; Summoning — **Seals and Pentacles**.

DOMINANT ARCANUM

Magician (I), with one exception. You spent your life teaching. At one stone, for one night, you became something else — a Hermit (IX), hiding instead of giving — and you never explained it, even to yourself.

SIMULACRUM	<i>d100 · or choose</i>
01-55	a runemaster , one of the tradition cutting the demigods' catalog into stone across Sogn
56-70	a dead chieftain's heir , present when the last stone was laid
71-85	a völva presiding over the rite
86-00	a grave-thrall , tending the dead the stones protect

STASIS OBJECT	<i>d100 · or choose</i>
01-20	a cut memorial stone , smaller than the great slabs
21-40	a rune-stick — a carved wooden rod
41-60	a rune-cut whetstone
61-80	an iron graving-awl , the tool that cut the marks, not the marks themselves
81-00	a small stone amulet bearing a single rune
<i>Small enough to carry, cut by the same hand that cut the great stones.</i>	

runemaster
One of a tradition of carvers cutting demigod lore into memorial stone across early Sogn.

völva
A seeress who worked seiðr; welcomed and feared in equal part.

NOTABLE ERA SKILLS

Norse Lore · Runes · Sorcery (Lower) · Stonecraft / carving · Funerary rite.

Skíringssalr

Vestrför — the westward voyage

c. 793–830



THE PALADINS' ULTIMATE WEAPON, USED AGAINST NEPHILIM

You remember Aachen the way you remember a wound closing over dirt: the idols burning, the ones who had worn your kind's shape for a thousand years cut down beside them, and you running north with nothing but the shape of a promise — *find where they are still awake*. Kaupang took you in. The trading-beach, the smoke of a hundred hearths, a tongue you learned to make your own. You never stopped being the one who ran.

One man you remember by his shadow before his face — a Paladin, one of the twelve, a blade that caught torchlight wrong, too bright, too hungry. A comrade beside you did not fall the way men fall. He simply **stopped** — no wound you could see, no cry, only the space where he had been standing going, all at once, empty. Ordinary death you understood: the body fails, the Nephilim waits, a new life comes for it eventually, the way spring comes. This was not that. There was no waiting left to do. You understood then, watching nothing where a friend had been, that some ends have no other side — and that the twelve carried that ending on their belts, and called it holy work. That is why you ran, and why you came back armed.

R

Aachen, 782

Charlemagne ordered the mass execution of some 4,500 Saxons at Verden after their revolt — the atrocity that drove refugees north.

M

The Paladins

Charlemagne's twelve legendary champions; here, hunters of the old gods' kind, wherever the empire's reach still ran.

The ships took you south again — the same water that had carried you north as a refugee now carrying you back as something closer to a weapon. The monastery came up gray out of the fog, bells going, and you went in with the rest and did not hesitate — an old man with a cross raised the alarm and you put him down before he finished raising it, and two more after him, brothers who had done nothing to you but wear the coats of the ones who had done everything. And in the same reeking hour, in a locked room behind the altar, you found her: small, cold, wrapped in cloth gone to dust, a sleeping one of your own kind, stolen as treasure by men who never knew what they carried. You lifted her out yourself. You do not remember whether your hands were still red when you did it.

Coming home, you told it as reclaiming, and mostly believed yourself. But some nights the ledger runs the other way — the monks were only monks, dead men who had been children once, and the sleeper you saved might have woken regardless, in someone else's hands, a hundred years on. You cannot make the two weigh even. You have stopped trying.

†

Orichalka

The anti-Ka substance that annihilates a Nephilim's Ka on contact, permanently destroying its eternal soul rather than merely injuring its Simulacrum.

B

Justice (XI)

The Arcanum dominant in this life — the same cold arithmetic that once raised an empire, turned to bring it down.

WHAT YOU MUST ANSWER AT THE TABLE

You ran from Aachen and lived; others did not run fast enough. Does that make you the lucky one, or only the one who left first? Have you told the others what you saw the Paladin do, or do you carry that silence alone, afraid that naming it makes it truer? At the monastery, did you kill because they stood between you and her, or because they were simply there and you were owed a killing? And the sleeper you carried home — was she the reason for the voyage, or only the reason you tell yourself now, so the rest of it can be called a rescue?

Skíringssalr (Kaupang), Vestfold

C. 793-830 A.D. · *Vestrfr*

See the fragment above for what remains of it; below is only what you choose.

OCCULT ART AVAILABLE

Sorcery — **Lower**, **Higher** and **Grand Secret** techniques; Summoning — **Seals** and **Pentacles**.

DOMINANT ARCANUM

Justice (XI). The same cold arithmetic that once raised an empire, carried north and turned to bring it down.

SIMULACRUM <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01-35	a survivor of Aachen who rose to lead the raid, vengeance made into a purpose
36-55	a Frankish-born guide , leading the raiders to places he used to call home
56-70	a helmsman , continent-born, who learned Norse waters and piloted the fleet
71-85	a skald , whose songs carried the voyage home as a story before the ships even landed
86-93	a shield-maiden who sailed for the reclaiming, not the raiding
94-00	a thrall-turned-warrior , freed to fight, uncertain to this day which side truly freed him

STASIS OBJECT <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01-30	a sword taken in the raid
31-55	an arm-ring , given or won
56-75	a ship's vane (weathervane), carried home from the voyage
76-00	a reliquary taken back from a burning abbey — its saint's bones long since discarded
<i>Plunder, and the occasional thing plunder was never meant to be.</i>	



skald

A court poet; oral history and reputation-making rolled into one office.



shield-maiden

A woman recorded as bearing arms in raiding parties, rarer in the sources than in later legend.

NOTABLE ERA SKILLS

Norse Lore · Seafaring · Sorcery (Lower) · Weapons (Viking-Age) · Speak Frankish/Latin.

Hafrsfjorðr

Eitt ríki — one kingdom

c. 872



STILLNESS ON GROUND THAT ALREADY KNEW HIS WEIGHT

The water off Hafrsfjord was still full of wreckage when you first understood what had actually happened: not a battle won, but an ending. Ships broken to driftwood, men you had called king face-down in a slush of blood and salt, and one man left standing over all the wreckage of it, already looking north before anyone else had finished dying. You do not remember, now, whether you cheered him or wept for the others — only that you followed, because there was nowhere else left to stand.

He chose Qgvaldsnes for his seat before the blood on his hands had dried, and you went with the household that raised it. And the moment your feet found that ground, something in you went quiet in a way that had nothing to do with the king, or the war, or the new order being hammered into shape around you. The earth there did not feel new. It felt *tended* — the way a grave is tended, or a wound that has closed over something that never actually healed. You told no one. There was nothing to tell; you had no memory to point to, only the certainty, bone-deep and useless, that you had grieved something on that exact spot before you had a name for grief.

↑

Hafrsfjord

Later sagas date the traditional unification battle to 872; skaldic sources point historians toward the 880s–900s instead.

⌘

Haraldshaugen

A monument at Haugesund, raised in 1872, marks the traditional battle site a millennium on.

You watched him build his hall on it anyway, watched the old scattered kingdoms bend or break into his one, and you could not have said — cannot say now — whether you thought it was mercy or theft. A hundred small freedoms ended so that one great order could begin; you have met men who call that a kindness and men who call it the first lie a nation ever tells itself, and some days you have been both of those men in the same hour.

What stays is not the king, or the war, or even the new order. What stays is the ground — how it received you like it already knew your weight, how the quiet there was not empty but *occupied*, by something with no story left attached to it. You have never gone back. You do not think you could bear to find out the quiet was still waiting.

✂

Avaldsnes again

The site has near-continuous elite occupation from the Bronze Age on — often called Norway's oldest royal seat.

I

Emperor (IV)

The Arcanum dominant in this life: many made one, whatever the many thought of it.

WHAT YOU MUST ANSWER AT THE TABLE

When the old kingdoms fell into one — did you help break them, or only watch, and does the difference matter to you now? And at Qgvaldsnes, when the ground went quiet under you — was that grief for something you once did there, or only the shape grief leaves behind when everything else has been taken from it?

Hafrsfjörðr / Þgvaldsnes

C. 872 A.D. · *Eitt ríki*

See the fragment above for what remains of it; below is only what you choose.

OCCULT ART AVAILABLE

Sorcery — **Lower**, **Higher** and **Grand Secret** techniques; Summoning — **Seals** and **Pentacles**.

SIMULACRUM <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–25	a warrior in the king’s retinue
26–45	a petty king, or his skald
46–65	a shipwright
66–85	a völv
86–00	a bóndi (farmer) swept into the war

DOMINANT ARCANUM

Emperor (IV). You believed many should become one, whatever the many thought of it — and you were there when it happened.

STASIS OBJECT <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–30	a sword carried through the battle
31–55	a ship’s figurehead fragment, salvaged or kept
56–75	a rune-stone fragment
76–00	a chieftain’s arm-ring
<i>Plunder and remembrance from a kingdom just forged.</i>	

Þ
bóndi

A free landholding farmer — the backbone of the Norse assembly system.

R
shipwright
Builder of the longships that made both the raids and the unification wars possible.

NOTABLE ERA SKILLS

Norse Lore · Seafaring · Sorcery (Lower) · Oratory / court skills · Weapons (Viking-Age).

Nidarós

Óláfr hinn helgi

1024–1031



LIFTING THE SHROUD, "RED IN THE CHEEKS AS IF HE HAD JUST FALLEN ASLEEP"

You remember rooms, not halls. A bishop's chamber, a tent behind the lines, the low murmur of men deciding things before the men outside were told they had been decided. You were trusted the way a useful shadow is trusted — no one named what you were, and you let them not ask, and in exchange you sat close enough to lean in and be heard. Influence without a title is still influence. You told yourself that mattered more, not less, for being quiet.

You had reasons that were not the bishop's reasons, and you have never been sure how much that matters. You remember a child left out on a hillside because a hard winter had made the house choose, and no law asked the house to answer for it. You remember a feud that ate three farms and two generations because no man was above the men doing the killing. The old gods asked nothing of the powerful that the powerful did not also decide to give. You had watched that too long to call it merely different from what came after — you had started, quietly, to want it stopped.

†

Moster, 1024

The traditional site of the Mostratingen assembly, where Christian law was proclaimed under Olaf II and Bishop Grimkjell.

†

Stiklestad

Olaf II Haraldsson was killed here on 29 July 1030, fighting to reclaim the throne.

Moster, and the law read aloud, and you standing near enough to have helped shape the words that were read. Something in you loosened that had been clenched for longer than you could name — here, finally, a leash even a king could not slip. You did not cheer. You felt relief, and then, a half-breath later, the first cost of it: a hall you had once sheltered under, ordered dark. You had wanted the leash. You had not let yourself picture whose neck else it would close around.

Stiklestad took you down before it took him — a spear or an arrow, you no longer trust which, only the grass coming up too fast and the noise of the field going strange and far. You did not die. You lay in it long enough to watch him carried past, already more story than man, and to understand, with the clean cruelty of fever, that you would live to see what they made of this.

A year later, at Niðarós, you stood near enough again to smell it: the lid lifted, the old bishop's voice gone reverent, a corpse that should have rotted and had not. You knew things about preservation and cold ground that the men crossing themselves did not — and you said none of it. You watched a king become a saint over the space of one held breath, on ground that was, until that morning, only ground. You helped build the thing that would one day come looking for your own kind, and you cannot say, even now, that you would refuse to help build it again.

Σ

Olav the Holy

His body was reportedly found undecayed a year after death; he was declared Norway's patron saint, and Nidaros Cathedral later rose on the site.

†

Judgement (XX)

The Arcanum dominant in this life — present at a grave that opened, watching the living decide what came out of it.

WHAT YOU MUST ANSWER AT THE TABLE

When the law was read at Moster — did you help write words that freed you, or words that would one day hunt you, and did you already know which? At Niðarós, when the lie became a relic in front of you — did you stay silent to protect yourself, or because some part of you wanted it to be true? And the leash you wanted so badly — now that you have felt it close, is it still the mercy you thought it was?

Niðarós (Trondheim)

1024-1031 A.D. · Óláfr hinn helgi

See the fragment above for what remains of it; below is only what you choose.

OCCULT ART AVAILABLE

Sorcery — **Lower, Higher and Grand Secret** techniques; Summoning — **Seals and Pentacles**.

DOMINANT ARCANUM

Judgement (XX). You stood at a grave that opened, and watched the living decide what to call what came out of it.

SIMULACRUM	<i>d100 · or choose</i>
01-20	a clerk or scribe in Bishop Grimkjell's household
21-40	an interpreter , moving between Norse and Latin at councils
41-60	a counsellor without office — trusted, never named to a post
61-80	a housecarl of rank in Olaf's hird, close enough to the king's ear to be listened to
81-00	a minor priest or deacon in Grimkjell's retinue

STASIS OBJECT	<i>d100 · or choose</i>
01-35	a carved church portal fragment, salvaged from a building since rebuilt or burned
36-70	a reliquary , empty or holding something that isn't a saint's bone
71-00	a scrap of the original burial shroud from Stiklestad, kept without ever admitting why
<i>Church-made and church-adjacent objects, fitting a life spent in a bishop's orbit.</i>	

NOTABLE ERA SKILLS

Church Latin · Christian Rite & Doctrine · Oratory / Counsel · Norse Lore (the old ways, held at arm's length) · Sorcery (Lower/Higher/Grand Secret).

B
bird
A king's sworn retinue of household warriors.

M
housecarl
A ranked, landed member of that retinue — soldier and courtier both.

Björgvin

Mann dauðr — the great dying

1349



SINKING INTO THE WHITE

There was incense, and it did not cover the smell — tar and salt off the wharves, and beneath it something soft and terrible, more dead than the ground could hold. This time you kept yourself hidden. There was a cross over every door now, and men who would burn what you were if ever they glimpsed it, so you went among them as one of them — a healer, a wise one, someone who "knew things," and only that. You remember the smallness of it, the care it took, after having once been known.

And still they came, hands open, and looked at you the way the drowning look at a far shore. They were right to. You understood the dying better than any physician among them; you could feel the wrongness in the air like a turn of weather. You held power they could not dream of — and it was not enough, and they did not know that, and you could not tell them.

I

Black Death

Reached Norway in 1349 through Bergen, reputedly aboard an English ship.

†

Bryggen

Bergen's wharf district was a major Hanseatic League trading post from the 14th century on.

There was a walking. You almost have it — a line of places you were meant to reach, in an order that mattered more than your life, a certainty warm as fever that if you only arrived the world would be gentle again. You did not arrive. Something gave way — someone beside you went down into the white, or the winter closed its hand, or a thing you cannot bear to look at happened at the edge of the light.

What stays is not the dying. It is the guilt — soft, enormous, without a shape. In the dream you did everything right; you were good, you were trying to save them, and still it turned to ruin in your hands, and no one has ever told you why.

B

Toll on Norway

Estimates put population loss from the plague years at roughly half of Norway's people.

I

Temperance (XIV)

The Arcanum dominant in this life — the belief that every living thing deserves to survive, even as the working said otherwise.

WHAT YOU MUST ANSWER AT THE TABLE

When the walking failed — did you turn back and stay with the sick to the end, a healer though you knew it hopeless? Or did you press on alone toward the place you never reached, certain the many outweighed the few? And the version you keep — the one where you were good, where you did everything right — is that what happened, or only the shape of it you could bear to carry out of the white?

Björgvin (Bergen)

1349 A.D. · *Manndauðr*

See the fragment above for what remains of it; below is only what you choose.

OCCULT ART AVAILABLE

Sorcery — **Lower, Higher and Grand Secret** techniques; Summoning — **Seals and Pentacles**; Alchemy — **Black Stone** (*the first Norway era past the rulebook's 12th-century Alchemy gate*).

SIMULACRUM <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–25	a physician or barber-surgeon
26–45	a priest
46–60	a plague-corpse bearer
61–80	a Bryggen (Hansa) merchant
81–00	a wise-woman / healer

DOMINANT ARCANUM

Temperance (XIV). You believed, all the way down, that every living thing deserves to survive — even as the working said otherwise.

STASIS OBJECT <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–35	a reliquary carried for protection that did not protect
36–70	a votive church-object, left as an offering against the dying
71–00	a plague-amulet — folk protection worn alongside, or instead of, the church's
<i>Plague-era objects, the sacred and the desperate sitting close together in 1349.</i>	

◦ **barber-surgeon**
A tradesman-physician, performing surgery and bloodletting alongside a physician's other trades.

⌘ **votive object**
An offering left at a shrine, given in hope rather than in payment for a cure already worked.

NOTABLE ERA SKILLS

Healing · Religion · Bryggen / Hanseatic trade · Sorcery (Lower/Higher/Grand Secret) · Summoning (Seals).

Vargøy

Mørketid — the polar dark

c. 1620–1663



A PATCH OF DARK DENSER THAN THE DARK AROUND IT

Innmark keeps no daylight in the dark months, and you searched anyway, because the others said the place you sought lay somewhere under that unbroken night. You remember the cold less than you remember the listening — the particular quiet of a land with no sun to fill it, and the sense, growing each night of the search, that the quiet was listening back.

It followed for three nights before you let yourself believe it. Not an animal — animals move *toward* something, hunger or warmth or fear, and this moved the way a held breath moves: at the edge of sight, gone when you turned, always slightly wrong, as if the dark had a shape it was not supposed to have. Once you heard your own name in a voice that had no business knowing it. You never saw it whole. You are still not sure you wanted to. What you did know, in your body before your mind caught up, was that it was not stupid, and it was not idle, and it *wanted* — the way a starving thing wants, patient because patience costs it nothing.

I

Vardo trials

Finnmark's witch trials, 1621–1663, were among the most severe in Scandinavia.

I ♪

Over 90 dead

Most of those executed were women; a number were Sámi.

You broke off the search. You told the others it was the cold, the season, bad ground — anything but the truth, which was that something out there had learned the shape of you, and you did not want to be the thing it finished learning. It did not matter. Within the month the accusations began — a dead cow, a sick child, a neighbour's bad dream — the same tired reasons dressed up as evidence, and your name was already the kind that outsiders distrust before they have a cause.

The burning itself you remember in pieces, the way the body protects itself from a whole memory of pain: rope, smoke thicker than it should have been, a crowd that would not meet your eyes because meeting them would have made it murder instead of justice. Somewhere in the smoke you thought of the thing in the dark, still out there, still patient, and understood with a clarity that felt like the only mercy left to you: they had gone to such trouble to burn the wrong thing.



Steilneset

A 2011 memorial
(Zumthor / Bourgeois)
at Vardø now
commemorates the
trials' victims.



Moon (XVIII)

The Arcanum
dominant in this life —
drawn to what shifts
and what hides.

WHAT YOU MUST ANSWER AT THE TABLE

You never saw it whole — do you still try, some nights, to complete the shape from memory, or has not-knowing become its own kind of peace? When they came for you, did you consider naming what you'd truly found in the dark, or did you already know no one would believe the truth over the lie? And the last clear thought you had, in the smoke — was it mercy, or was it the only anger you had left, dressed up as calm?

Vargøy (Vardø), Finnmark

C. 1620–1663 A.D. · *Mørketid*

See the fragment above for what remains of it; below is only what you choose.

OCCULT ART AVAILABLE

Sorcery — **Lower**, **Higher** and **Grand Secret** techniques; Summoning — **Seals** and **Pentacles**; Alchemy — **Black Stone** and **White Stone**.

SIMULACRUM <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–20	a fisherman’s wife
21–45	a Sámi noaidi, or their kin
46–60	the fogd’s clerk (the district sheriff’s household)
61–80	a midwife / wise-woman
81–00	a fisher

DOMINANT ARCANUM

Moon (XVIII). You were drawn to what shifts and what hides — perhaps that is why you noticed the thing in the dark before anyone else did.

STASIS OBJECT <i>d100 · or choose</i>	
01–30	a silver brooch
31–60	a rune-drum (runebomme)
61–80	a bone amulet
81–00	a knife
<i>Snatched from the ashes, the water, or the cell, by whoever still dared.</i>	



noaidi

A Sámi shamanic practitioner — spiritual specialist, healer, and mediator with the unseen.



fogd

A royal district administrator, combining sheriff and tax-collector duties.

NOTABLE ERA SKILLS

Norse Lore · Sámi Lore · Survival (Arctic) · Sorcery (Lower/Higher/Grand Secret) · Speak (Sámi or Norwegian, whichever isn’t native).

The Elder Futhark

2ND–8TH C. CE
24 CHARACTERS · 3 ÆTTIR

The oldest runic alphabet, in use across the Proto-Norse world roughly the 2nd–8th centuries CE. Twenty-four characters, arranged in three groups of eight (the *ættir*). Its name comes from the sounds of its first six runes: **f · u · þ · a · r · k**. A player investigating inscriptions, place-names, or old texts can match findings against this table — the same way a real historian would (Rygh's *Norske Gaardnavne*, runology handbooks, museum catalogues).

FREYR'S ÆTT		
𐀀	Fehu	cattle, wealth, mobile property
𐀃	Uruz	aurochs (wild ox), primal strength, vitality, health
𐀆	Thurisaz	thorn; giant (jötunn); crushing, destructive force
𐀇	Ansuz	a god (the Æsir); breath, speech, the divine word, inspiration
𐀉	Raidō	riding, a journey, the wheel, the right path
𐀋	Kaunan	a torch, light, illumination — or a sore/ulcer, disease (Old Norse <i>kaun</i>)
𐀌	Gebō	a gift, exchange, generosity, partnership
𐀍	Wunjō	joy, harmony, a wish fulfilled

HAGAL'S ÆTT		
𐀎	Hagalaz	hail; sudden, widespread destruction from the sky
𐀏	Naudiz	need, necessity, constraint, hardship, the need-fire
𐀐	Isa	ice, standstill, stasis
𐀑	Jera	year, harvest, the turning cycle, fruition
𐀒	Eihwaz	the yew tree; the world-tree's axis; death and rebirth; endurance
𐀓	Perþ	the lot-cup; chance, fate; the hidden; mystery, secrets
𐀔	Algiz	protection, warding; the elk; a link to the divine
𐀕	Sowilō	the sun; victory, success, wholeness; the guiding star

TÝR'S ÆTT		
𐀖	Tiwaz	the god Týr; justice, war, sacrifice, honour
𐀗	Berkanan	the birch; birth, growth, fertility, new beginnings
𐀘	Ehwaz	the horse; partnership, movement, trust, steady progress
𐀙	Mannaz	man, mankind, humanity, the self, the mind
𐀚	Laguz	water; lake, sea, rain; flow; the unconscious, emotion
𐀛	Ingwaz	the god Ing/Freyr; a seed, gestation, potential that takes root
𐀜	Dagaz	day, dawn, daylight; breakthrough, awakening, transformation
𐀝	Opala	an inherited estate; heritage, ancestral land, homeland, legacy

𐀓
Uncertain
Some meanings are genuinely disputed in scholarship (Perþ, Eihwaz); the commonest reconstructions are given, and a few runes carry more than one traditional sense.

𐀀
ætt
A "family" of eight runes. Plural *ættir*.